NASA

One-page brief

Priority: 16 of 33 (score 3.0). **FY2026 outlays:** $23B (USAspending). **As of:** 2026-10-27. Public data only.

Bottom line

NASA spends most of its budget on a few very large contracts, where fraud is about cost mischarging that public data cannot see. The public-data opening is small business research money (SBIR/STTR) and the supplier base under the large primes, where the SBA checks apply.

Exposure

- $23B in outlays in FY2026.
- SBIR/STTR duplicate funding and misuse are recurring NASA OIG cases; GAO found about $445M in possibly duplicative SBIR awards across agencies.

Public data we can use

- **SBIR.gov** award data; **NASA TechPort** project data.
- **FPDS / USAspending** contracts and subawards.
- **SAM.gov** entities and exclusions; NASA OIG reports.

Detection plays

1. **Duplicate research awards** across agencies (shared with doe.pdf and nsf.pdf).
2. **Award-mill firms:** firms with many SBIR Phase I awards and no Phase II or commercialization record.
3. **Supplier screen:** subcontractors under large primes tied to excluded parties or sharing addresses with the prime.

First prototype

Include NASA in the cross-agency SBIR duplicate-award screen.

Limits

Geodesic Solutions: geodesic.pro *Contact: Steve Taylor, Managing Partner: taylor@geodesic.pro*

Cost-plus contract mischarging and labor fraud are invisible in public data.

Who to take it to

NASA OIG, NASA Office of Small Business Programs.

Sources

- GAO-24-105470: SBIR/STTR fraud vulnerabilities
- SBIR.gov awards data
- USAspending agency profiles (FY2026 outlays)